

The Numbers Behind the Decision

Three tables that tell you what the brochure never will. Check all three before signing the admission form.

TABLE 1 — Fees to Justified Salary

What annual salary justifies the fees? Based on recovering total 4-year cost within 2 years of starting work. **Rule:** if the college's NIRF median salary is below this number — walk away.

Annual Fee	4-Year Total Cost	Min. Justified Salary
₹50,000	₹2,00,000	₹3,50,000
₹1,00,000	₹4,00,000	₹4,50,000
₹1,50,000	₹6,00,000	₹5,50,000
₹2,00,000	₹8,00,000	₹6,50,000
₹2,50,000	₹10,00,000	₹7,50,000
₹3,00,000	₹12,00,000	₹8,00,000
₹5,00,000	₹20,00,000	₹10,00,000

TABLE 2 — Monthly Take-Home Reality Check

Tax is ₹0 for CTC up to ₹12L (Section 87A rebate, new regime FY2025-26). Cost of living minimum: ₹20,000/month. **Highlighted row = ₹12L breakeven point.**

Annual CTC	Monthly Gross	Tax /mo.	Take-Home	Cost of Living	Surplus /mo.
₹3.5L	₹29,167	₹0	₹29,167	₹20,000	₹9,167
₹4L	₹33,333	₹0	₹33,333	₹20,000	₹13,333
₹5L	₹41,667	₹0	₹41,667	₹21,000	₹20,667
₹6L	₹50,000	₹0	₹50,000	₹22,000	₹28,000
₹8L	₹66,667	₹0	₹66,667	₹23,000	₹43,667
₹10L	₹83,333	₹0	₹83,333	₹25,000	₹58,333
₹12L	₹1,00,000	₹0	₹1,00,000	₹28,000	₹72,000
₹15L	₹1,25,000	₹8,750	₹1,16,250	₹35,000	₹81,250
₹18L	₹1,50,000	₹13,333	₹1,36,667	₹42,000	₹94,667
₹20L	₹1,66,667	₹16,667	₹1,50,000	₹48,000	₹1,02,000
₹25L	₹2,08,333	₹27,500	₹1,80,833	₹58,000	₹1,22,833

Above ₹12L: tax at 15% ₹12–16L), 20% ₹16–20L), 25% ₹20–24L), 30% (₹24L) — new income tax regime.

TABLE 3 — Education Loan Reality Check

12% annual interest, compounded monthly. 4-year moratorium (course + 6 months). 5-year repayment. **Highlighted row = ₹3L/yr — the most common private college fee tier.**

Annual Fee	Borrowed	Balance After 4 Yrs	Monthly EMI	Total Repaid	Interest Paid
₹50K/yr	₹2,00,000	₹3,22,445	₹7,173	₹4,30,380	₹2,30,380
₹1L/yr	₹4,00,000	₹6,44,890	₹14,345	₹8,60,700	₹4,60,700
₹1.5L/yr	₹6,00,000	₹9,67,336	₹21,518	₹12,91,080	₹6,91,080
₹2L/yr	₹8,00,000	₹12,89,781	₹28,690	₹17,21,400	₹9,21,400
₹2.5L/yr	₹10,00,000	₹16,12,226	₹35,863	₹21,51,780	₹11,51,780
₹3L/yr	₹12,00,000	₹19,34,671	₹43,036	₹25,82,160	₹13,82,160
₹5L/yr	₹20,00,000	₹32,24,452	₹71,726	₹43,03,560	₹23,03,560

At ₹3L/yr: you borrow ₹12L, but by the time you start repaying, you owe ₹19.3L. Your EMI is ₹43,036/month for 5 years. Check if the college's median NIRF salary can sustain this.

This cheat sheet is from **How Not to Choose Your College — Engineering Edition**
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